

GEOGRAPHY

INDIAN GEOGRAPHY



INDIAN PHYSIOGRAPHY

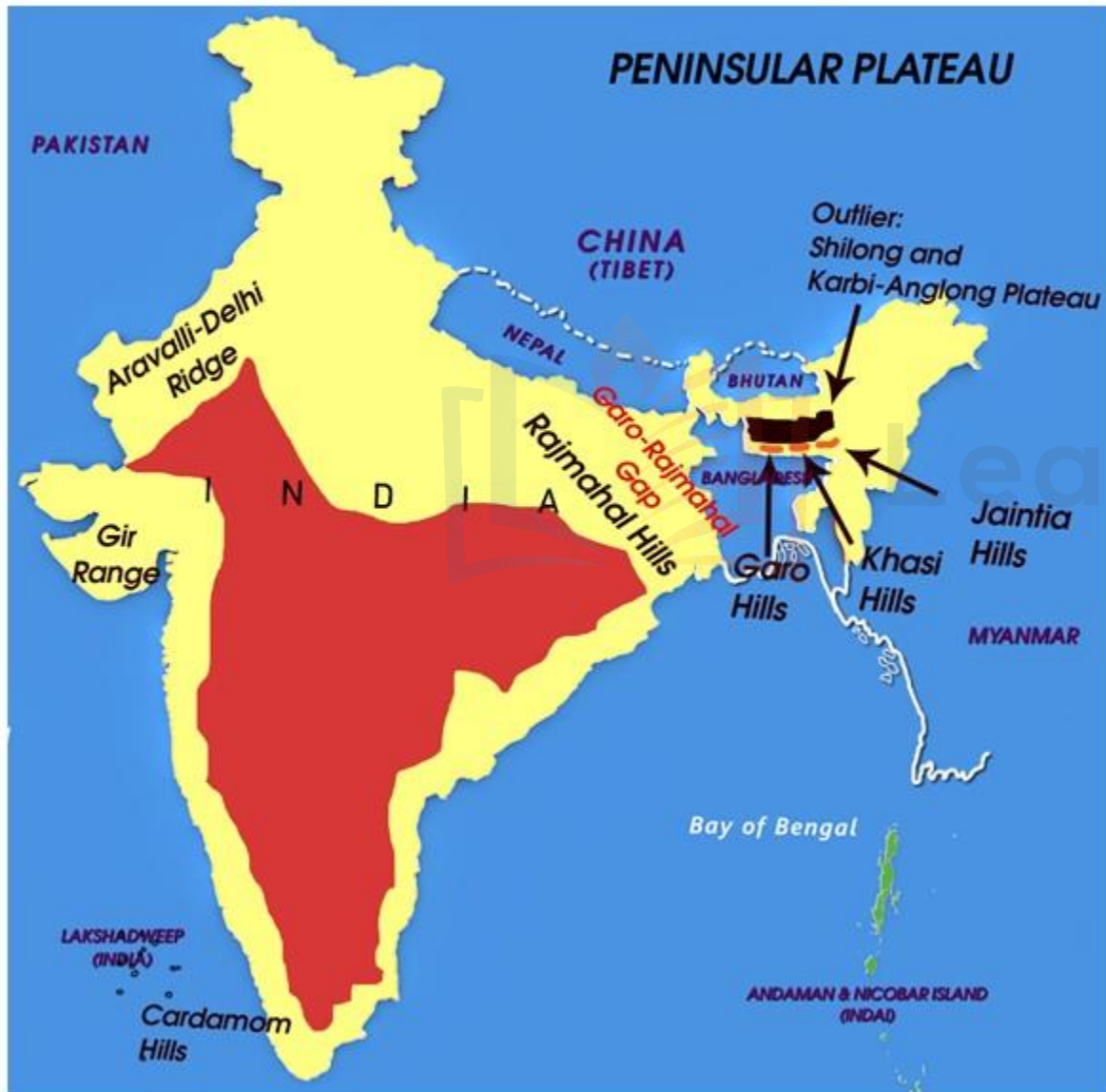
MODULE - 6

PHYSIOGRAPHIC DIVISIONS **THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU**



3

THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU



1

Rising from the height of 150 m above the river plains up to an elevation of 600-900 m is the triangle shaped Peninsular plateau.

2

The northern boundary is an irregular line running from Kuchchh along the **western flank of the Aravalli range** to near Delhi and thence roughly parallel to the Yamuna and the Ganga as far as the **Rajmahal Hills** and the **Ganga delta**.

3

Delhi ridge in the northwest, (extension of Aravalis), **the Rajmahal hills** in the east, **Gir range** in the west and the **Cardamom hills** in the south constitute the outer extent of the Peninsular plateau.

3

THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU



4

However, an extension of this is also seen in the northeast, in the form of **Shillong and Karbi-Anglong plateau**.

5

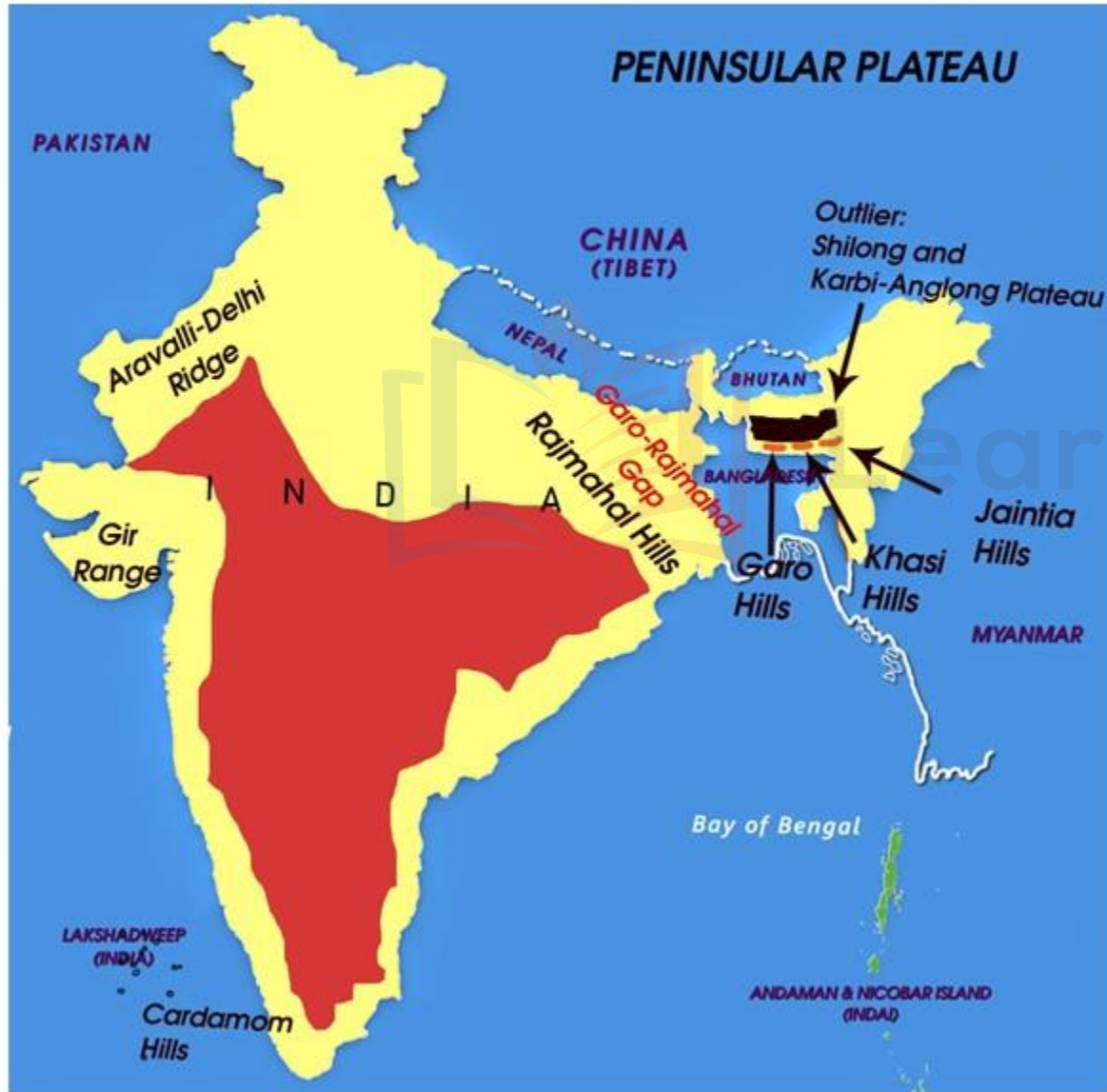
The Peninsular India is made up of a series of plateaus such as the Chotanagpur plateau, the Malwa plateau, the Marwar plateau and the Karnataka plateau, etc.

6

This is one of the oldest and stable landmass of India.

3

THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU



7

The general elevation of the plateau is from the west to the east, which is also proved by the pattern of the flow of rivers.

8

Some of the important physiographic features of this region are block mountains, rift valleys, bare rocky structures, series of hummocky hills and so on.

9

The western and northwestern part of the plateau has an emphatic presence of black soil.

10 These spatial variations have brought in elements of diversity in the relief of the Peninsular plateau.



11 The northwestern part of the plateau has a complex relief of ravines and gorges.

12 The ravines of Chambal, Bhind and Morena are some of the well-known examples.





N E P A L

BHIND

UTTAR PRADESH

RAJASTHAN

Banas

CHAMBAL

MORENA

Yamuna

Ganges

GUJARAT

MADHYA PRADESH

CHHATTISGARH

1 The Peninsular plateau is an ancient tabular block composed mostly of the Archaean gneisses.

2 It has been a stable shield, which has gone through little structural changes since its formation.

3 Ever since the dawn of geological history the peninsula has been land area and has never been submerged beneath the sea except few places.

4 Peninsular Plateau is an aggregation of several smaller plateaus and hill ranges interspersed with river basins and valleys.

5 A brief description of these plateaus, hill ranges and the intervening river valleys will be of great help in describing the relief of this great plateau.

PART 1

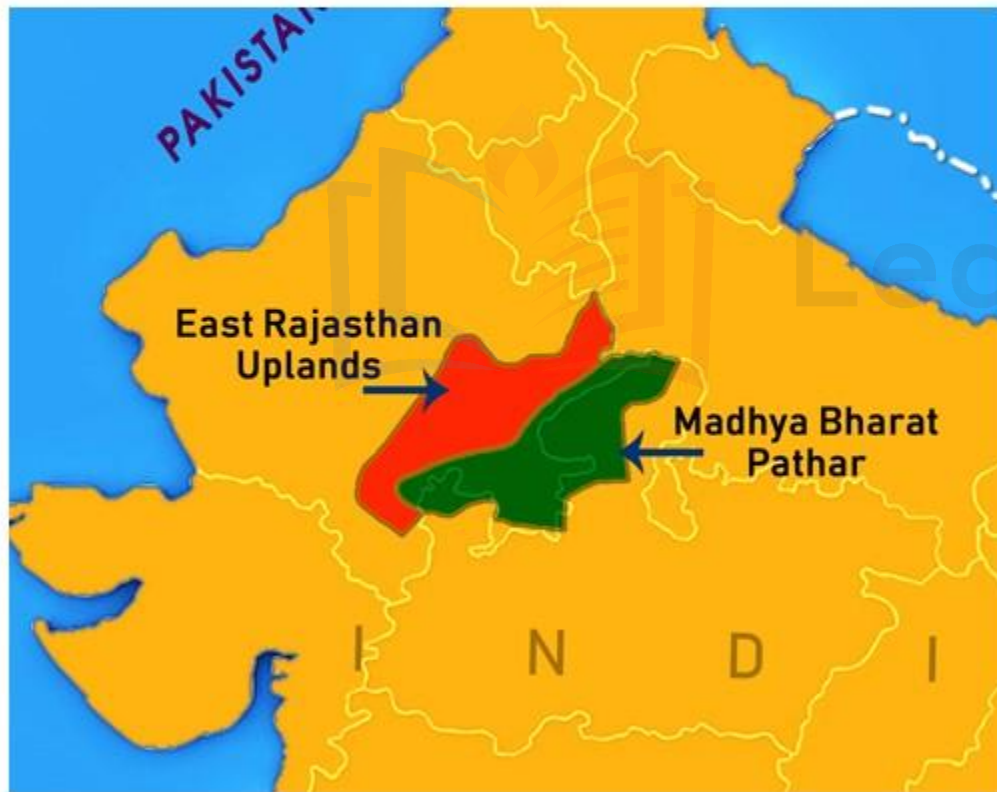


WHAT DO YOU MEAN BY ROLLING PLAIN?

Rolling plains are not completely flat, there are slight rises and fall in the landform

Example: Prairies of USA

- 1 It is also called the **Eastern Rajasthan Uplands** as it lies in the east of Aravali ranges.
- 2 The average elevation is 250-500 mts above the sea level & it slopes eastwards.
- 3 It is made up of sandstone, shales, limestones of the Vindhayan period.
- 4 The **Banas river** originates in the Aravali ranges and flows towards northwest into the Chambal river.
- 5 This area has been carved into a rolling plain by the erosional work of the Banas river and its tributaries.



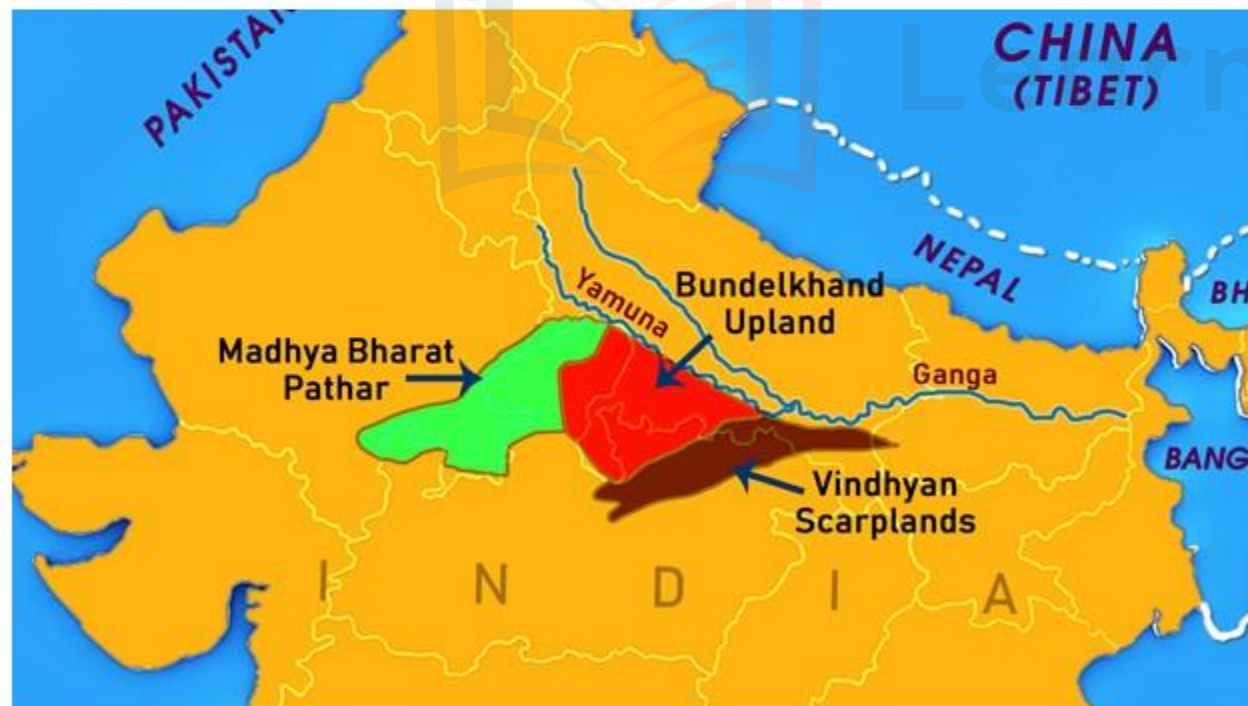
- 1 It is also called the Madhya Bharat Plateau & it is present in the east of Marwar Upland.
- 2 Most of the plateau comprises of the basin of Chambal river.
- 3 It is open rolling plateau made up of old rocks which is interspersed with rounded hills composed of sandstone.
- 4 To the north are the ravines or badlands of the Chambal river.



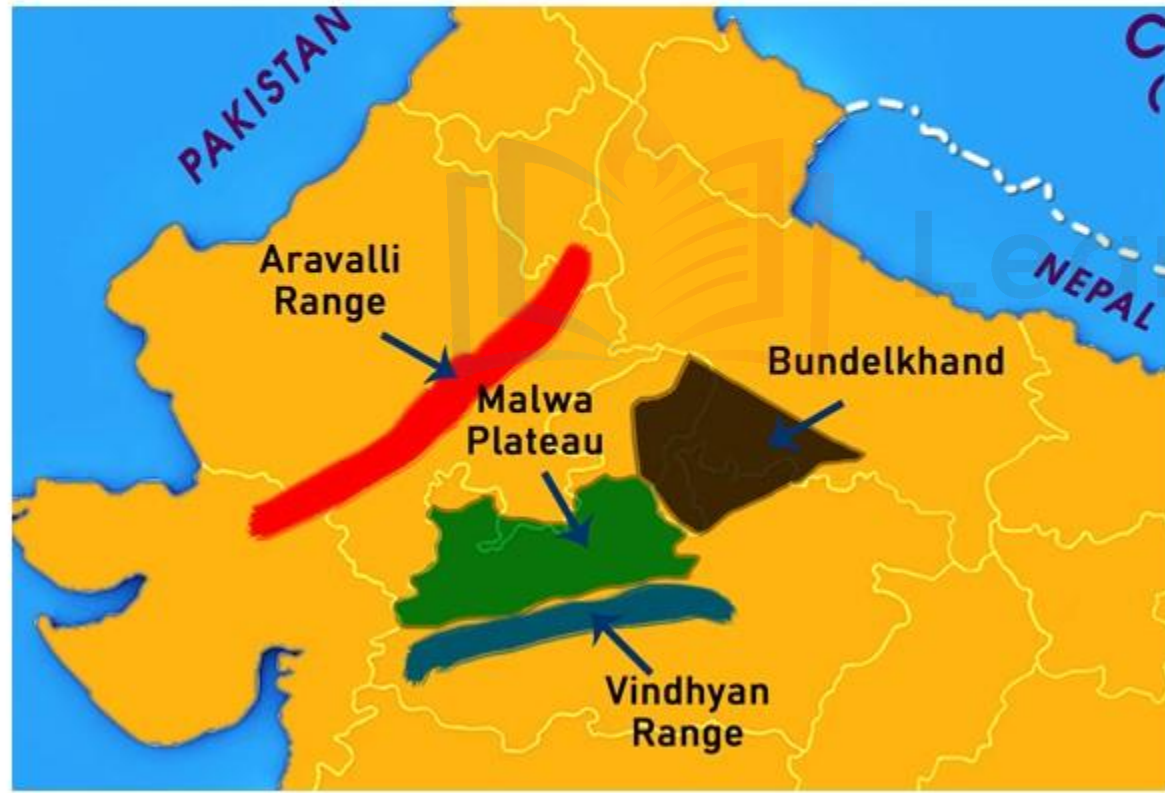
1 To the south of the Yamuna river between Madhya Bharat Plateau and the Vindhyan hills is the **old dissected upland of the “Bundelkhand Plateau”, which is made of granite.**

2 Spread over five districts of Uttar Pradesh and four district of Madhya Pradesh with an average elevation of 300 to 600 mts above sea level, this area slopes down from the Vindhyan scarp towards the Yamuna River.

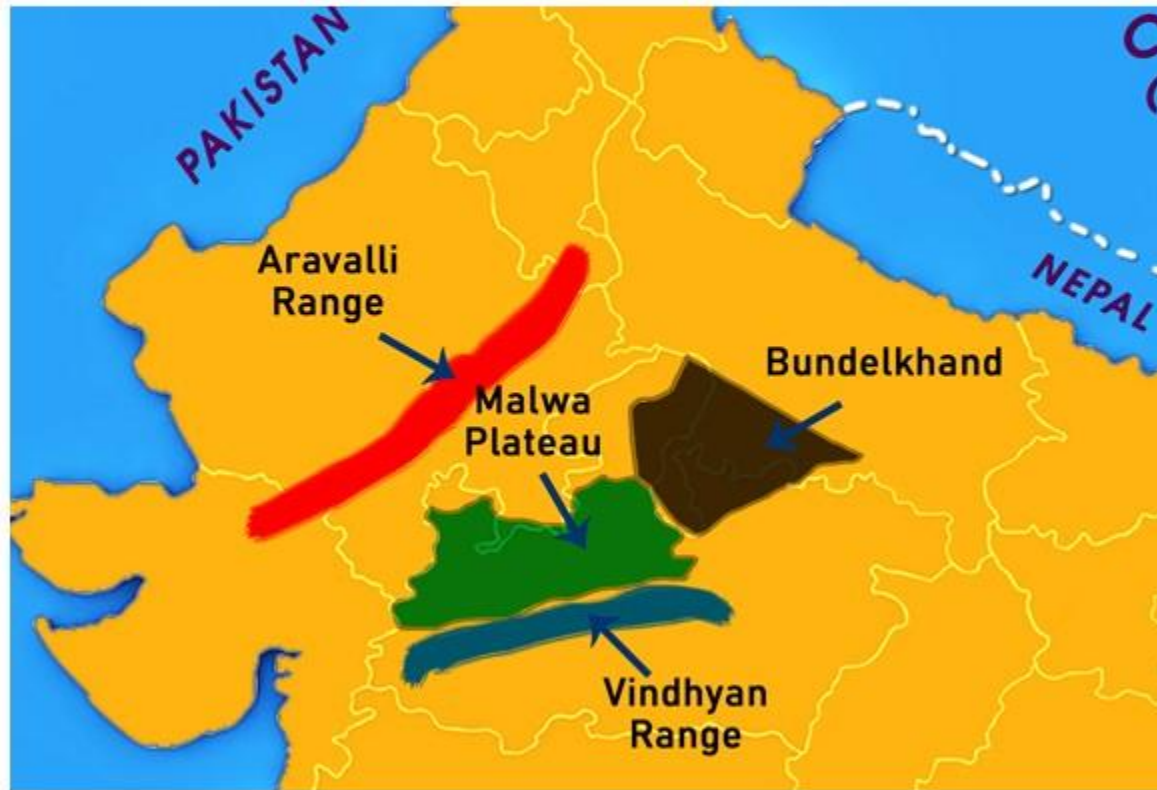
- 3 The area is recognized by the mass of rounded hills which is made of granite and sandstone.



- 4 In the northwest and the northeast, the system is covered by Ganga, Yamuna alluvium and in the southwest by Deccan trap.
- 5 The erosional work of the rivers flowing here have converted into an undulating area and rendered it unfit for cultivation.
- 6 Streams like Ken and Betwa have carved out steep gorges in this plateau.



- 1 This plateau roughly forms a triangle based on the Vindhyan Hills, bounded by the Aravalli Range in the west and Bundelkhand to the east.
- 2 The plateau inherits a complex geology- none of the other peninsular group of plateau possess such a character.
- 3 This plateau has two systems of drainage; one towards the Arabian sea (The Narmada, the Tapi and the Mahi) and the other towards the Bay of Bengal (Chambal and Betwa, joining the Yamuna).



4 It is composed of extensive lava flow and is covered with black soils.

5 The general slope is towards the north, there are rolling surfaces and flat topped hills dissected by rivers flowing through the area

6 In the north, the plateau is marked by the Chambal ravines.



- 1 North of the Maikal Range is the Baghelkhand plateau.
- 2 It is made of limestones and sandstones on the west and granite in the east.
- 3 It is bounded by the Son river on the north.
- 4 The central part of the plateau acts as a water divide between the Son drainage system in the north and the Mahanadi river system in the south.
- 5 The region is uneven with an elevation varying from 150 m to 1,200 m.

- 1 Chotanagpur plateau represents the north-eastern projection of the Indian Peninsula Plateau.



- 2 It covers an area of 87,000 sq kms mostly present in Jharkhand, northern part of Chhatisgarh and Purulia district of West Bengal.
- 3 The Son river flows in the north-west part of the plateau and joins the Ganga.
- 4 The average elevation of the plateau is 700 m above sea level.
- 5 The plateau is drained by numerous rivers and streams in different directions.

3

THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

CHOTANAGPUR PLATEAU

PART 6



6 Some of the important rivers of this region are Damodar, the Subarnrekha, the North Koel, the South Koel etc.

7 The Damodar river flows through the middle of this region in a rift valley from west to east. Here are found the Gondwana coal fields which provide bulk of coal in India.

8 North of the Damodar river is the Hazaribagh plateau. This plateau has isolated hills.

9 To the south of the Damodar valley lies the Ranchi plateau.

10 The Rajmahal Hills forms the north eastern edge of the Chotanagpur Plateau.



1

The rocks of the peninsular plateau of India extend further northeast beyond the Rajmahal hills and form a rectangular block known as **Meghalaya or the Shillong plateau**.

2

This plateau has been separated from the main block of the peninsular plateau by a wide gap known as the **Garo-Rajmahal Gap**.

3

THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

THE MEGHALAYA PLATEAU

PART 7



3

The plateau slopes down to Brahmaputra valley in the north and the Surma and Meghna valleys in the south.

4

The western, central and the eastern parts of the plateau are known as the Garo Hills, the Khasi-Jaintia Hills and the Mikir Hills.

5

Shillong is the highest point of the plateau.

1 This is the largest unit of peninsular plateau of India covering an area of about five lakh sq km.

2 It is triangular in shape

3 It is bounded by the **Satpura** and the **Vindhya** in the north-west, **Maikal** ranges in the north, the **Western Ghats** in the west and the **Eastern Ghats** in the east.

4 Its general slope is from west to east which is indicated by the flow of its major rivers like the **Mahanadi**, **Godavari**, **Krishna** and **Cauvery**.

5 These rivers have further subdivided the plateau into a number of smaller plateaus described as under.

INDIAN PHYSIOGRAPHY



3

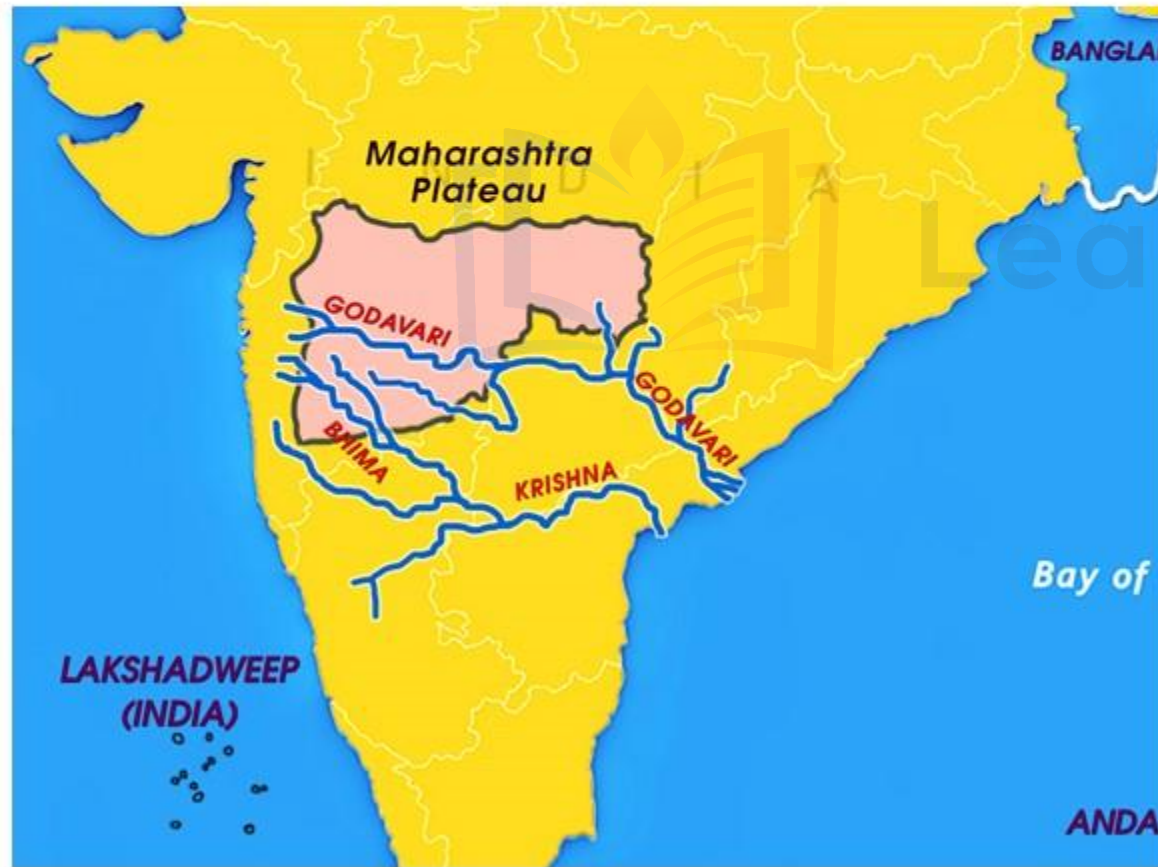
THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

THE DECCAN PLATEAU

A

MAHARASHTRA PLATEAU

PART 8



1

It lies in Maharashtra and forms the northern part of Deccan plateau.

2

It comprises of the **basaltic rocks of lava origin**.

3

The **horizontal lava sheets** have led to the formation of **typical Deccan step-like topography**.

4

The entire area is covered by black cotton soil which is also known as **Regur**.

5

The rivers such as Godavari, Bhima and the Krishna flows in this plateau

3

THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

THE DECCAN PLATEAU

B

KARNATAKA PLATEAU

PART 8



1

The Karnataka Plateau is also known as the **Mysore Plateau**.

2

It lies to the south of the Maharashtra plateau

3

It is highly dissected by numerous rivers rising from the Western Ghats.

4

It contains the **heads of the Tungabhadra and the Kaveri rivers**.

5

The highest peak is at Mullayanagiri in Baba Budan Hills in Chikkamagaluru district of Karnataka.

3

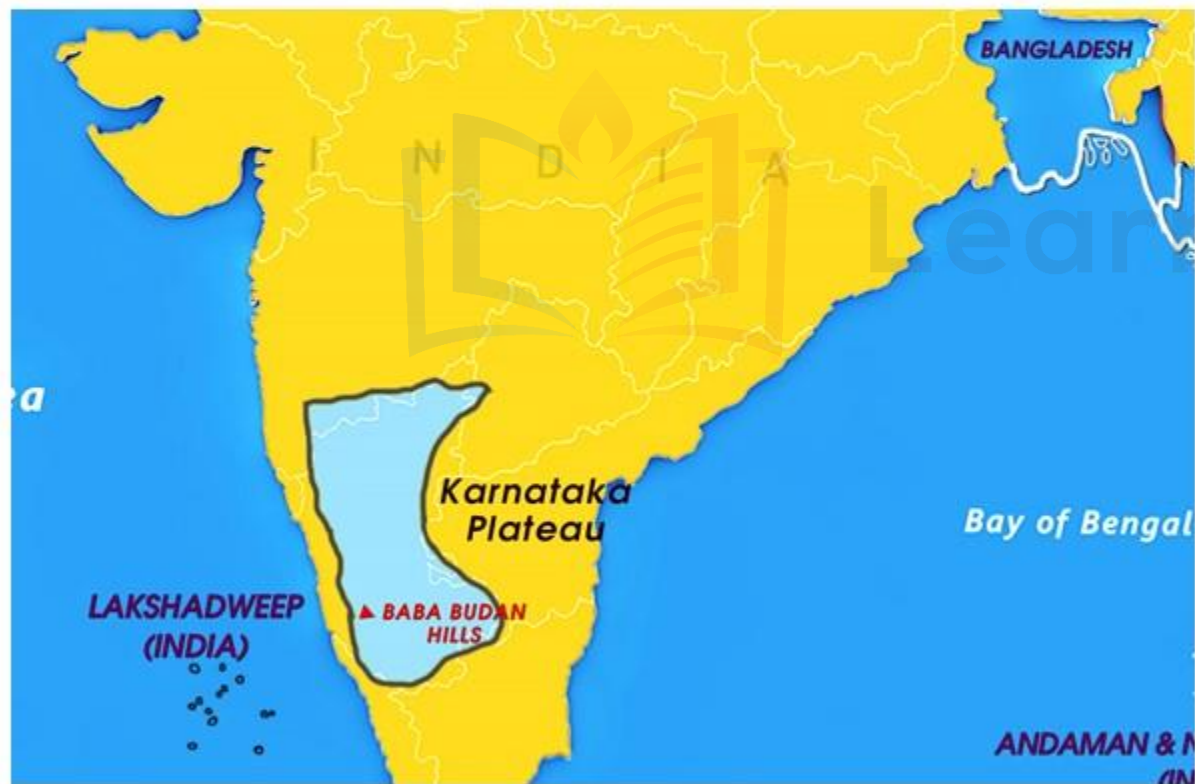
THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

THE DECCAN PLATEAU

B

KARNATAKA PLATEAU

PART 8



6

The plateau is divided into two parts called **Malnad** and **Maidan**.

7

Malnad in Kannada means hill country, Maidan on the other hand is formed of the rolling plains with low-granite hills.

8

The plateau merges in the south with the Nilgiri Hills.

3

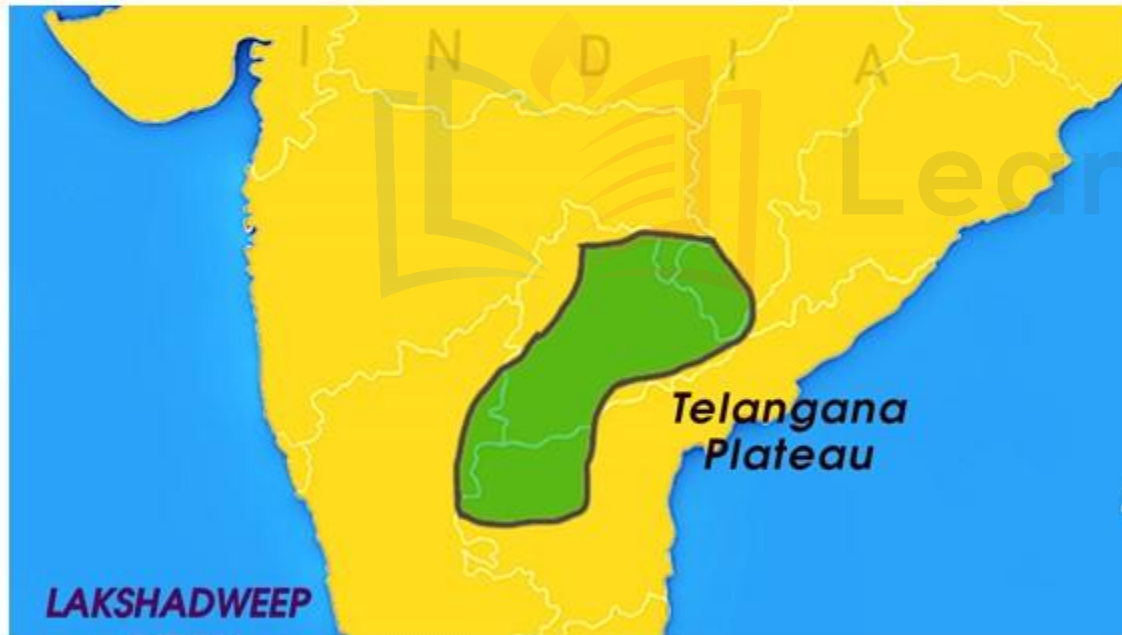
THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

THE DECCAN PLATEAU

C

TELANGANA PLATEAU

PART 8



1

The Telangana Plateau in Andhra Pradesh has an average elevation of 500-600 metres.

2

Its southern part is higher than its northern part.

3

The region is drained by 3 river systems the Godavari, the Krishna, and the Penneru.

COMPILATION OF ALL THE MAPS GIVEN IN THE FOLLOWING SLIDES

1 MARWAR UPLAND

2 MADHYA BHARAT PLATEAU

3 BUNDELKHAND UPLAND

4 THE MALWA PLATEAU

5 THE BAGHELKHAND

6 CHOTANAGPUR PLATEAU

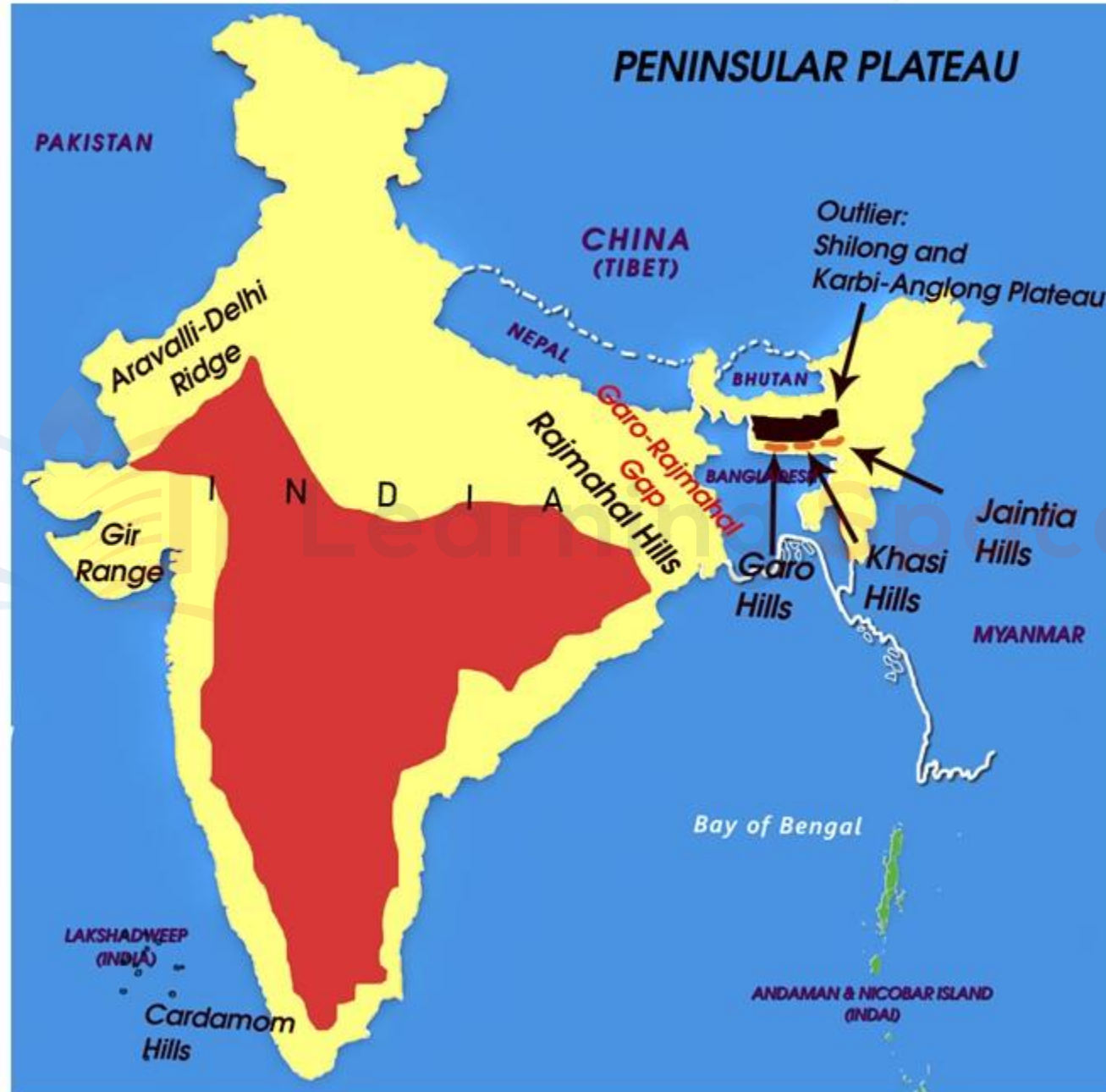
7 THE DECCAN PLATEAU

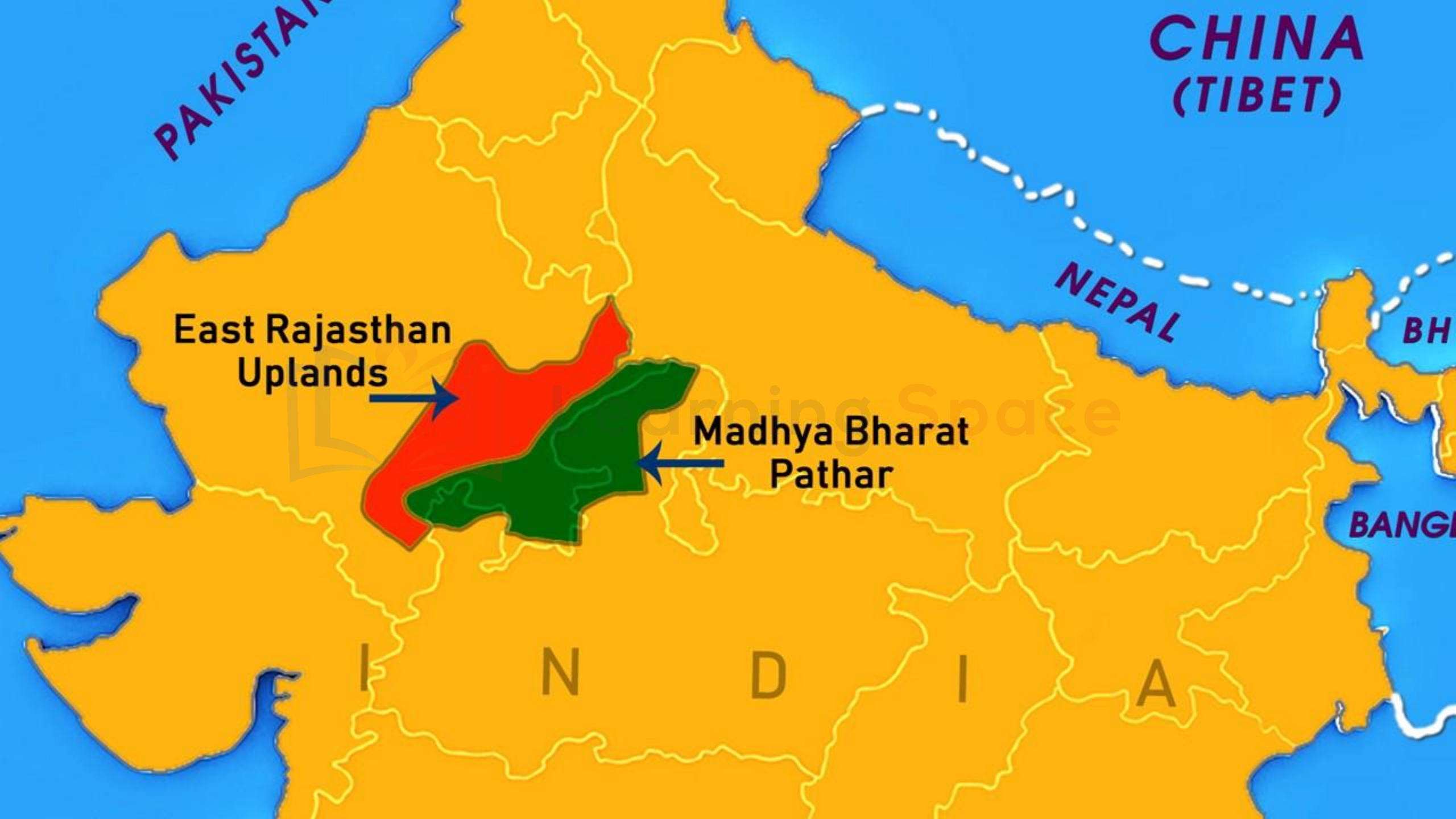
8 MAHARASHTRA PLATEAU

9 KARNATAKA PLATEAU

10 TELANGANA PLATEAU

INDIAN PHYSIOGRAPHY





PAKISTAN

CHINA
(TIBET)

NEPAL

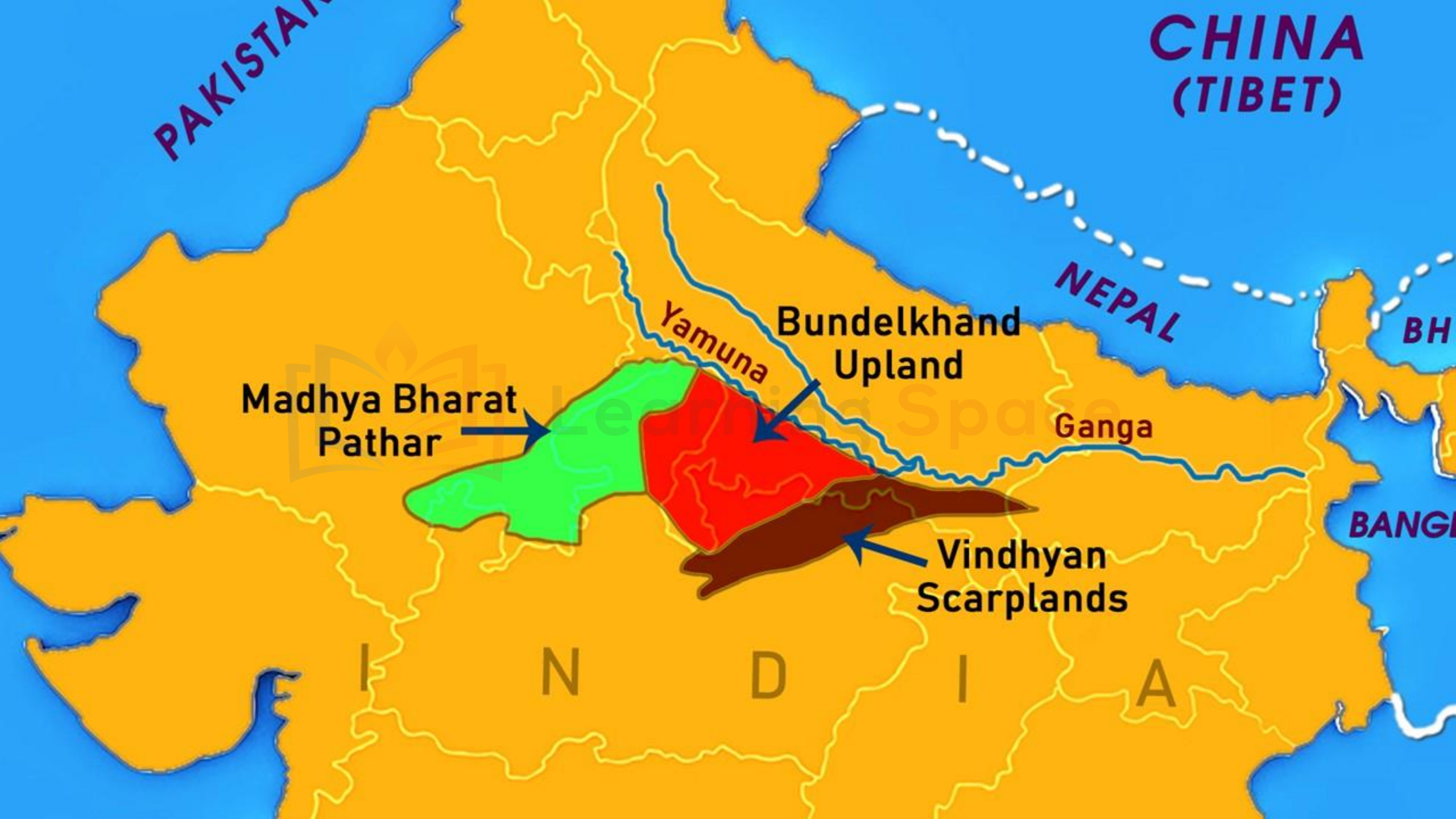
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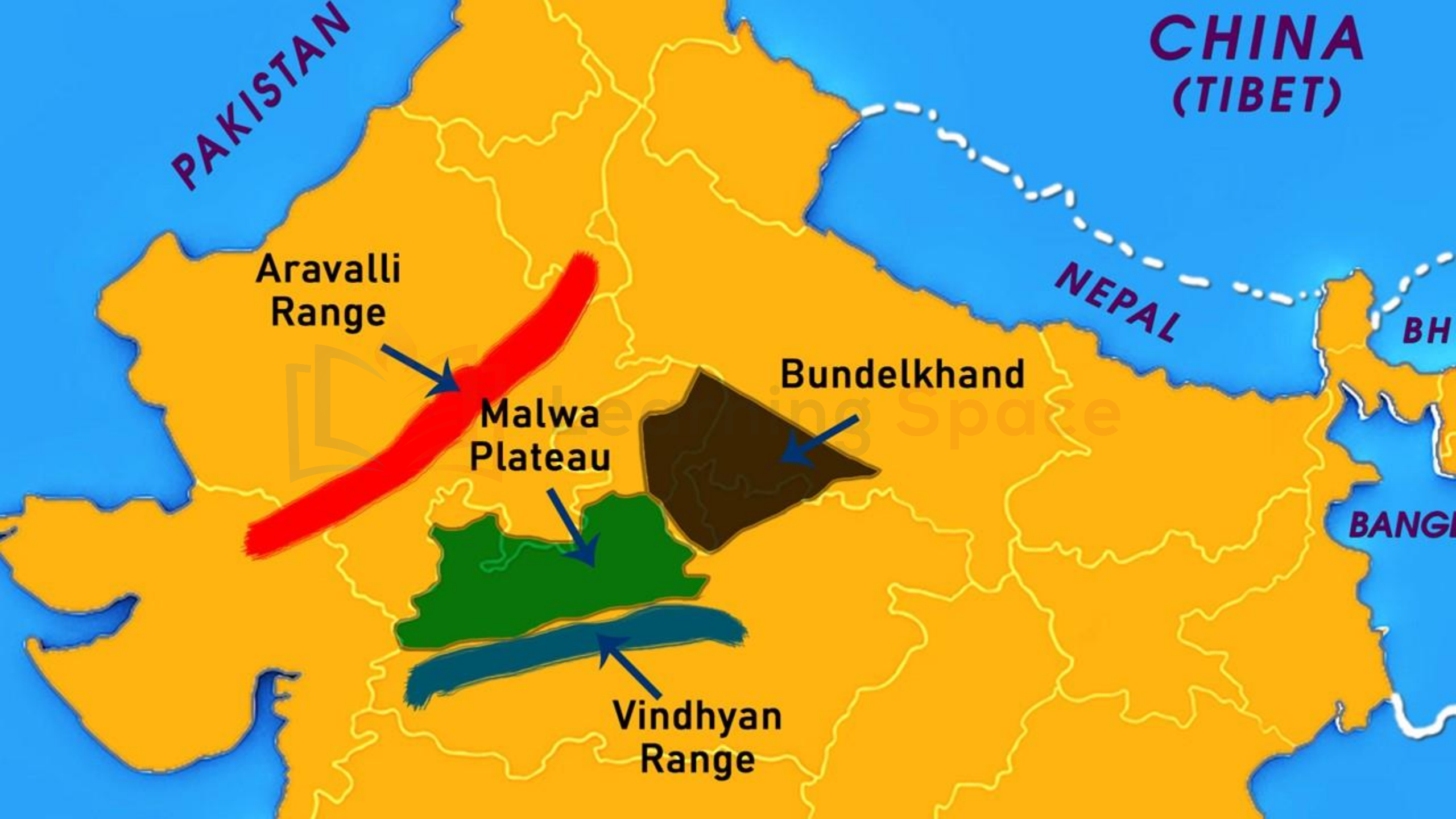
East Rajasthan
Uplands

Madhya Bharat
Pathar

BANG

I N D I A





PAKISTAN

CHINA
(TIBET)

Aravalli
Range

NEPAL

Bundelkhand

Malwa
Plateau

Vindhyan
Range

BH

BANG





NEPAL

BHUTAN

Rajmahal Hills

BANGLADESH

Damodar

Chotanagpur
Plateau

INDIAN PHYSIOGRAPHY





BANGLADESH

Maharashtra
Plateau

GODAVARI

GODAVARI

BHIMA

KRISHNA

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

LAKSHADWEEP
(INDIA)

ANDAMAN & N
(IN



BANGLADESH

I N D I A

Arabian Sea

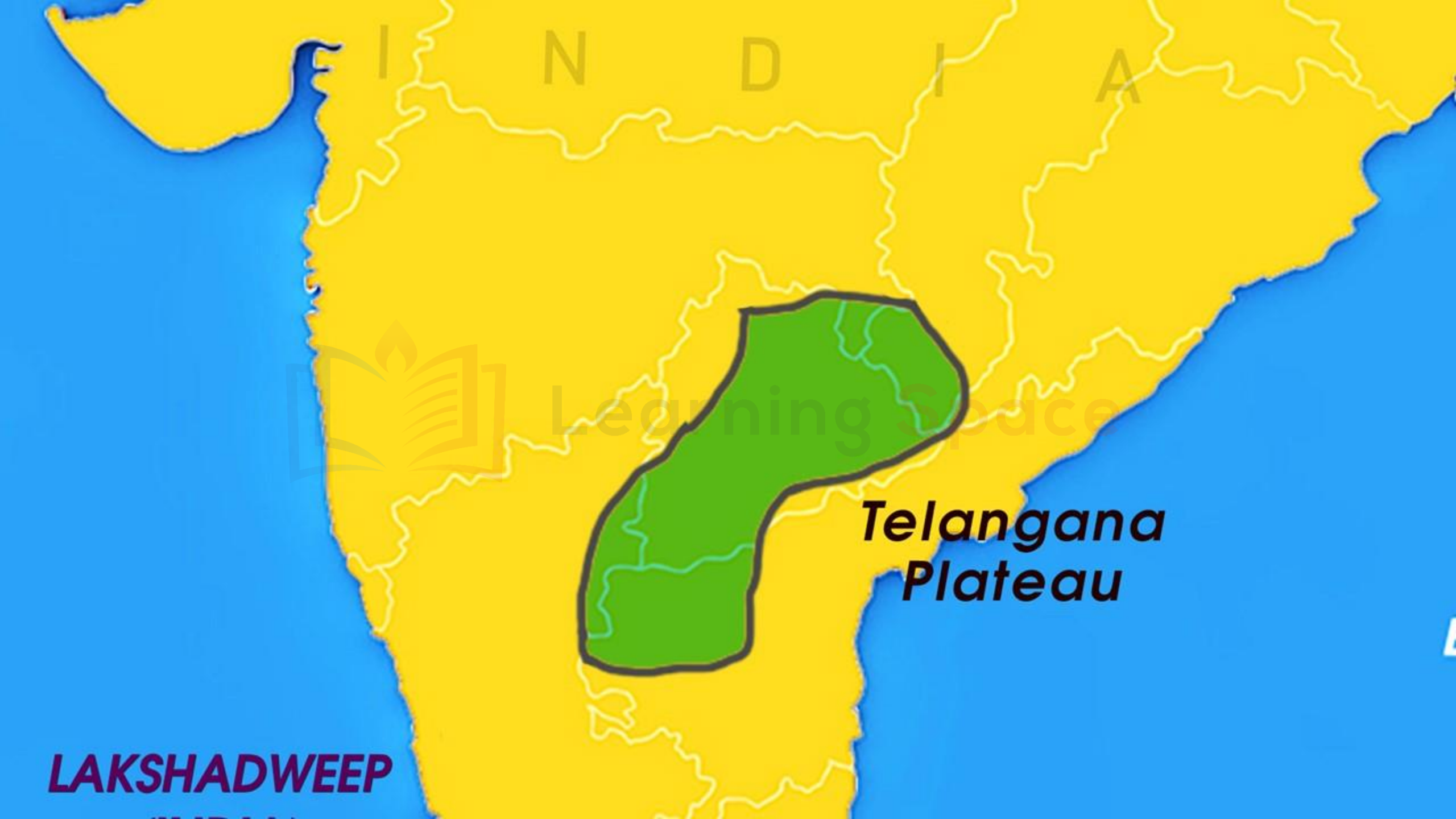
LAKSHADWEEP
(INDIA)

Karnataka
Plateau

▲ BABA BUDAN
HILLS

Bay of Bengal

ANDAMAN & N
(IN



LAKSHADWEEP

**Telangana
Plateau**

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